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To Whom it May Concern:

For the past 9 years, I have worked professionally as an Electrical Engineer after receiving my BS in Computer Engineering from the Rochester Institute of Technology in 2017. My most recent job at FTL Labs Corp, for the past 7 years, has challenged me to grow in many fields. FTL is a company that targets SBIR grants and my role has included a spectrum of Engineering disciplines. I have done RF X-band RADAR development, mechanical product design, power supply design, as well as a host of testing and documentation. I am good at context switching and relish the opportunity to learn new skills. One fantastic example of my skills is the Sharpscan marine RADAR for the Army. This is a modification of a COTS RADAR for submarine use. I personally designed the RF subsystem, wrote the VHDL code for the sampling system, and designed and executed component and system level testing for this complicated system.

As a younger person, like many of us, I wanted to be an Astronaut. This dream met an untimely end when I was diagnosed with Ankylosing Spondylitis, a form of arthritis related to a genetic defect. Despite this, I believe myself to be an excellent candidate for this Flight Analog position. I raise this directly for two reasons, first, out of respect for your time; second, to give an explanation as to why I believe this shouldn't disqualify me, as this might be my biggest detractor. Physically, the only change is a slight loss of mobility, which has never gotten in the way of my demanding life. I have passed a FAA Class 3 Medical to fly recreationally, I hike actively, I fix cars and motorcycles, I dance, and I generally live a very physical life. Logistically, my condition is easily managed through medication.

Personality-wise, my idea of adventure usually involves longer trips alone or with others, and I am used to being in the same room with the same 2-4 faces for months on end having been a night-shift tester testing submarine systems. I don't get bored easily, and I don't get frustrated with monotony or with high stress environments. I am extremely mechanically and electrically inclined, with excellent troubleshooting and repair skills.

This position is something I would be extremely proud of. I would love to advance science in this way, and believe I would be a fantastic Engineer-Analog, despite the checkbox on my medical application. I look forward to the next steps in this, and eagerly await a reply.

Regardless of your decision, genuinely thank you for your consideration,
Christopher R. Culpepper